

Chapter 68 Part 1

The autumn wind swept away withered branches and fallen leaves, and outside it was gloomy, as if it could rain at any moment.

Liang Shi was dazzled by Xu Qingzhu's smile. After a moment, realizing her slip of the tongue, she changed the subject, "It looks like it's going to rain again outside. Did you bring an umbrella?"

"Teacher Liang." Xu Qingzhu looked at her. "Did you hear something?"

Liang Shi pressed her lips together, knowing she couldn't escape the pit she'd dug for herself, so she said casually, "I was talking about myself. I'm a bit conflicted about whether or not to go find my parents."

Xu Qingzhu's gaze fixed tightly on her. After a long while, she sighed softly and said frankly, "Your own matters, you decide for yourself. But if you're trying to probe about my affairs, you can ask directly. I don't really like beating around the bush."

Liang Shi: "....."

When you were trying every possible way to probe before, I didn't see that you disliked beating around the bush!

She only grumbled quietly in her heart and didn't dare say it to Xu Qingzhu.

If she said it, she feared it would turn into another debate, and she couldn't withstand Xu Qingzhu's passive-aggressive remarks.

The main issue was that once Xu Qingzhu started being passive-aggressive, the atmosphere would always end up going in weird and strange directions.

She couldn't really handle it.

So she stubbornly said, "I really was asking about myself."

"So you do know something about what happened to me." Xu Qingzhu said, "Normally, wouldn't you first be curious that something like this also happened to me?"

Liang Shi: "....."

Trapped again.

Liang Shi looked at her and said helplessly, "Teacher Xu, the furthest road I've ever traveled in this life is the road of your schemes¹."

Xu Qingzhu zipped up her backpack, and Liang Shi smoothly picked it up before she could shoulder it.

Xu Qingzhu didn't refuse either, only smiled lightly. "I can only say that Teacher Liang is really bad at pretending."

"So... what do you think about it?" Liang Shi asked cautiously.

Since the conversation had already reached this point, if she didn't ask something, it wouldn't be worth enduring all that passive-aggressiveness.

After all, she still had a task to complete.

If she completed this task and scraped together some more, she might be able to gather enough for a down payment on a house in Haizhou City.

She couldn't help it—she had never liked renting.

She still remembered when she first earned money and wanted to buy a house, she'd shocked her agent and assistant, who all thought it was too early.

After all, entertainers spent far more time living in hotels than in their own houses, and hotels were reimbursed by the production crew. Buying a house wasn't cost-effective for her at all.

But Liang Shi said that having a house meant having a home.

She could enshrine her grandparents' ashes at home, having a place where she could rest at any time.

Even though it lacked the warmth of daily life, it was a space that belonged solely to her.

Back then, Sister Wang² said she had an obsession with buying a house.

And when she owned her own house, the feeling of satisfaction standing at the doorway was incomparable to any ordinary matter.

It was on par with the satisfaction of receiving unanimous praise after her movie was released.

Moreover, this all depended on Xu Qingzhu's attitude. If Xu Qingzhu also really wanted to know, then it would be a win-win!

Liang Shi's suppressed thoughts became active again.

Footnotes

¹ *"The furthest road I've ever traveled in this life is the road of your schemes"* - This is a play on a popular Chinese internet phrase "我走过最长的路就是你的套路" (literally "the longest road I've walked is the road of your schemes/tricks"), meaning someone has been repeatedly fooled or outmaneuvered by another person's tricks or manipulations.

² *Sister Wang* - Referring to Wang-jie (王姐), Liang Shi's agent mentioned earlier in the story. "Jie" (姐) means "older sister" and is used as a respectful form of address for women, particularly in professional settings.